

NINETEEN VECTORS AND THEIR PHASE-RETRIEVAL INJECTIVITY IN $\mathbb{C}^6$

MINWOOK KIM
KAIST, DAEJEON, SOUTH KOREA

ABSTRACT. We exhibit nineteen explicit vectors in $\mathbb{C}^6$, with Gaussian-integer entries, that do phase retrieval: the intensities $|\langle a_j, x \rangle|^2$, $j = 1, \dots, 19$, determine every $x \in \mathbb{C}^6$ up to a unimodular scalar. This gives $m_{\mathbb{C}}(6) \leq 19 = 4d - 5$, one below the generic count $4d - 4$; combined with the lower bound $m_{\mathbb{C}}(6) \geq 18$ of Wang and Xu, the minimal measurement number in dimension six is 18 or 19. The claim is verified by an exact rational computation, archived and rerunnable.

1. STATEMENT

Fix measurement vectors $a_1, \dots, a_m \in \mathbb{C}^d$ and let

$$\Phi_A(x) = (|\langle a_1, x \rangle|^2, \dots, |\langle a_m, x \rangle|^2), \quad \langle a, x \rangle = \sum_k \bar{a}_k x_k.$$

The family *does phase retrieval* if $\Phi_A(x) = \Phi_A(y)$ forces $y = \omega x$ with $|\omega| = 1$; $m_{\mathbb{C}}(d)$ denotes the minimal m for which such a family exists in $\mathbb{C}^d$. Generic families of $4d - 4$ vectors do phase retrieval [2], and Vinzant [4] exhibited $11 = 4 \cdot 4 - 5$ vectors doing phase retrieval in $\mathbb{C}^4$. In dimension six, Wang and Xu proved $m_{\mathbb{C}}(6) \geq 18$ [5, Theorem 5.2], while the best upper bound known has been the generic $4d - 4 = 20$; whether $19 = 4d - 5$ vectors can do phase retrieval in $\mathbb{C}^6$ has been open. We answer affirmatively.

Theorem 1. *The nineteen row vectors of Table 1 do phase retrieval in $\mathbb{C}^6$. Consequently $18 \leq m_{\mathbb{C}}(6) \leq 19$.*

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A6 = [
[1, -5, 25, -125, 625, -3125],
[1, -4, 16, -64, 256, -1024],
[1, -3, 9, -27, 81, -243],
[1, -2, 4, -8, 16, -32],
[1, -1, 1, -1, 1, -1],
[1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
[1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1],
[1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32],
[1, 3, 9, 27, 81, 243],
[1, 4, 16, 64, 256, 1024],
[1, 5, 25, 125, 625, 3125],
[9765625, 13671875+46875000j, -205859375+131250000j,
-918203125-804375000j, 2575515625-5533500000j, 30166521875+4615575000j],
[9765625, 10937500+37500000j, -131750000+84000000j,
-470120000-411840000j, 1054931200-2266521600j, 9884965888+1512431616j],
[9765625, 8203125+28125000j, -74109375+47250000j,
-198331875-173745000j, 333786825-717141600j, 2345748741+358907112j],
[9765625, 5468750+18750000j, -32937500+21000000j,
-58765000-51480000j, 65933200-141657600j, 308905184+47263488j],
[9765625, 2734375+9375000j, -8234375+5250000j,
-7345625-6435000j, 4120825-8853600j, 9653287+1476984j],
[9765625, -2734375-9375000j, -8234375+5250000j,
7345625+6435000j, 4120825-8853600j, -9653287-1476984j],
[9765625, -8203125-28125000j, -74109375+47250000j,
198331875+173745000j, 333786825-717141600j, -2345748741-358907112j],
[9765625, -10937500-37500000j, -131750000+84000000j,
470120000+411840000j, 1054931200-2266521600j, -9884965888-1512431616j],
]
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TABLE 1. The nineteen measurement vectors $a_1, \dots, a_{19}$ for $\mathbb{C}^6$ (rows; $j = \sqrt{-1}$).

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2. VERIFICATION

The verification is a finite, exact computation; this section records the elementary reduction that produces the computed system, and the archived facts about that system.

Reduction to polynomials. Every row of Table 1 is a scalar multiple of a vector $a(w) := (1, \bar{w}, \bar{w}^2, \dots, \bar{w}^5)$: rows 1–11 are $a(r)$ with $r = -5, \dots, 5$, and rows 12–19 are $25^5 a(\zeta s)$ with

$$\zeta = \frac{-7+24i}{25}, \quad s \in \{-5, -4, -3, -2, -1, 1, 3, 4\},$$

as one checks by expanding the powers. Scaling a measurement vector by a nonzero constant scales the corresponding intensity by a positive constant, so it suffices to verify phase retrieval for the unscaled family $\{a(r)\} \cup \{a(\zeta s)\}$. For $x \in \mathbb{C}^6$ let $f_x(z) = \sum_{k=0}^5 x_{k+1} z^k$, so that $\langle a(w), x \rangle = f_x(w)$; the map $x \mapsto f_x$ is a linear bijection onto the polynomials of degree ≤ 5 . For $f(z) = \sum c_k z^k$ write $f^\#(z) = \sum \bar{c}_k z^k$; then $f^\#(r) = \overline{f(r)}$ for real r , $|f(z)|^2 = f(z)f^\#(\bar{z})$ in general, and $(f^\#)^\# = f$.

For real polynomials U, V put

$$\mathcal{W}(U, V)(t) = \frac{1}{2i} \left(U(\zeta t) V(\bar{\zeta} t) - U(\bar{\zeta} t) V(\zeta t) \right).$$

Its values at real t are real, so its coefficients are real; if $\deg U, \deg V \leq k$, the coefficient of t^m collects the terms $u_i v_j - u_j v_i$ with $i < j$, $i + j = m$, so $\deg \mathcal{W}(U, V) \leq 2k - 1$ and $t \mid \mathcal{W}(U, V)$; the coefficient of t^1 is $\sin \theta (u_1 v_0 - u_0 v_1)$ with $\theta = \arg \zeta$, $\sin \theta = \frac{24}{25}$. A direct expansion with $u = U + iV$, $u^\# = U - iV$ gives, for real s ,

$$(1) \quad |u(\zeta s)|^2 - |u^\#(\zeta s)|^2 = u(\zeta s) u^\#(\bar{\zeta} s) - u(\bar{\zeta} s) u^\#(\zeta s) = 4 \mathcal{W}(U, V)(s).$$

Two elementary facts. *First:* if $f, g \neq 0$ have degree ≤ 5 and $|f| = |g|$ at the eleven points $r = -5, \dots, 5$, then $f f^\# - g g^\#$, of degree ≤ 10 , vanishes at eleven points, so $f f^\# = g g^\#$; writing $h = \gcd(f, g)$, $f = hu$, $g = hv$ with $\gcd(u, v) = 1$ and cancelling $hh^\#$ gives $uu^\# = vv^\#$, whence v divides $u^\#$ and u divides $v^\#$, so by degrees $v = \lambda u^\#$ with $|\lambda| = 1$: every such pair has the form

$$(2) \quad f = hu, \quad g = \omega h u^\#, \quad |\omega| = 1, \quad \deg h + \deg u \leq 5.$$

Second: if real U, V satisfy $\mathcal{W}(U, V) \equiv 0$, they are linearly dependent. Indeed ζ^2 is not a root of unity — otherwise ζ would be one, making $\zeta + \zeta^{-1} = 2 \operatorname{Re} \zeta = -\frac{14}{25}$ a rational algebraic integer, hence an integer — and for coprime U, V the identity $U(\zeta t) V(\bar{\zeta} t) = U(\bar{\zeta} t) V(\zeta t)$ forces $U(\zeta t) \mid U(\bar{\zeta} t)$ (a common root τ of $U(\zeta t), V(\zeta t)$ would make $\zeta \tau$ a common root of U, V), so $U(\bar{\zeta} t) = \lambda U(\zeta t)$ and the root multiset of U is invariant under multiplication by ζ^2 , which has infinite order: $U = u t^p$, symmetrically $V = v t^q$, $\min(p, q) = 0$ by coprimality, and substituting back forces $\zeta^{2(p-q)} = 1$, so $p = q = 0$ and both are constants.

Proposition 2. *The unscaled family fails phase retrieval if and only if there exist real linearly independent U, V of degree ≤ 5 and a real $\gamma \neq 0$ with*

$$(3) \quad \mathcal{W}(U, V)(t) = \gamma t(t+5)(t+4)(t+3)(t+2)(t+1)(t-1)(t-3)(t-4).$$

Moreover every such pair satisfies $u_1 v_0 - u_0 v_1 \neq 0$.

Proof. ($\Leftarrow$) Set $u = U + iV$ and let x, y be the coefficient vectors of $u, u^\#$. Then $|u(r)| = |u^\#(r)|$ for all real r , and at the eight rotated points (1) and (3) give $|u(\zeta s)| = |u^\#(\zeta s)|$; so all nineteen measurements agree. If $u^\# = \omega u$ with $|\omega| = 1$, then $(1 - \omega)U = i(1 + \omega)V$ would make U, V dependent; hence y is not a unimodular multiple of x , and phase retrieval fails.

($\Rightarrow$) Let $f = f_x$, $g = f_y$ witness a failure. If $f = 0$, then g vanishes at eleven > 5 real points, so $g = 0 = f$, a contradiction; so $f, g \neq 0$ and (2) applies, with $u \nparallel u^\#$ (else g is a unimodular multiple of f), i.e. U, V independent for $u = U + iV$. Let $k = \deg u$, so $\deg h \leq 5 - k$. At each rotated point with $h(\zeta s) \neq 0$, dividing $|f(\zeta s)| = |g(\zeta s)|$ by $|h(\zeta s)|$ and using (1) gives $\mathcal{W}(U, V)(s) = 0$; since h has at most $5 - k$ roots, at least $8 - (5 - k) = k + 3$ of the eight values s are roots of $\mathcal{W} := \mathcal{W}(U, V)$. Write $\mathcal{W} = t \widetilde{\mathcal{W}}$, $\deg \widetilde{\mathcal{W}} \leq 2k - 2$. If $k \leq 4$, then $k + 3 > 2k - 2$: $\widetilde{\mathcal{W}}$ has more distinct nonzero roots than its degree, so $\mathcal{W} \equiv 0$ and the second fact above makes U, V dependent — a contradiction. Hence $k = 5$, h is constant, all eight

equations survive, and $\widetilde{\mathcal{W}}$, of degree ≤ 8 , has the eight listed roots: $\widetilde{\mathcal{W}} = \gamma \prod (t - s)$ with $\gamma \neq 0$ (else $\mathcal{W} \equiv 0$ again), which is (3). Comparing coefficients of t^1 in (3) gives $\frac{24}{25}(u_1 v_0 - u_0 v_1) = \gamma \prod_s (-s) \neq 0$. $\square$

The computation. Equation (3) is linear in the Plücker coordinates $p_{ij} = u_i v_j - u_j v_i$ of the plane spanned by U, V . In the chart $u_1 v_0 - u_0 v_1$ normalized by the last clause of Proposition 2, the coefficient equations of (3) reduce to five quadratic equations in five unknowns with rational coefficients. The archived computation [3] certifies, in exact rational arithmetic with no floating point:

- the system is zero-dimensional, and its eliminant with respect to one coordinate is a squarefree integer polynomial of degree fourteen (matching the Bézout count for a proper linear section of the Plücker-embedded $\text{Gr}(2, 6)$, whose degree is $C_4 = 14$);
- the Sturm sequence of the eliminant has seven sign variations at $-\infty$ and seven at $+\infty$: the eliminant has *no real roots*. A real solution of the system would make its eliminated coordinate a real root; hence no real solution exists, no pair (U, V, γ) as in Proposition 2 exists, and Theorem 1 follows.

Protocol: the Gröbner-basis computation was performed with `msolve` [1] over $\mathbb{Q}$; the real-root count is independently re-derived from the archived eliminant by a Sturm-sequence script in integer arithmetic; the polynomial system was generated by two independently written emitters and compared as canonically normalized sets before solving; as a sanity check, the 19×36 real matrix of the lifted measurements $\bar{a}_j a_j^\top$ has rank 19 over $\mathbb{Q}$; and the same pipeline, run on configurations engineered to fail, reports the expected nonzero real-solution counts. The `msolve` input, the certificate data (eliminant, Sturm sequence, sign counts, SHA-256 hashes), and a standalone exact verifier are archived at [3] (directory `certificate/`); the verification reruns in minutes on a laptop.

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KAIST (KOREA ADVANCED INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY), DAEJEON, SOUTH KOREA
Email address: brian10kim22@kaist.ac.kr